

BIZINTEL

Design System v2.0

Tokens, Components & Accessibility Guidelines

Document Date: 15 July 2026

Prepared for: Product, Design & Engineering Stakeholders

Status: Draft for Stakeholder Review

Derived from: BizIntel BRD v1.0 and Brand Guidelines v1.0

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This design system translates the BizIntel Business Requirements Document (v1.0) and Brand Guidelines (v1.0) into a single, implementable source of truth: design tokens, reusable components, layout rules, and accessibility standards. It is written for product designers and front-end engineers building the self-serve, enterprise, and API-facing surfaces described in the BRD (Sections 7, 9 and 19).

1.2 How to Use This Document

- Designers: use Sections 2–6 (tokens) as the single source for color, type, spacing, grid and iconography — do not hand-pick values outside this palette.
- Engineers: implement Sections 2–6 as design tokens (e.g. CSS custom properties / a theme object) and Sections 7–12 as a shared component library consumed across web and dashboard surfaces.
- Everyone: Section 13 (Accessibility) is not optional — WCAG 2.1 AA is a stated BRD acceptance criterion (BRD Section 20).

1.3 Design Principles

These principles extend the BizIntel core values (BRD Section 3.4) into product design decisions:

- Evidence over decoration — every score, chart or claim on screen must be traceable to a rationale; visual weight follows evidence, not novelty.
- Clarity over density — first-time founders are a primary persona (BRD Section 16); default to generous spacing and plain language over dense enterprise-tool UI.
- Honest about uncertainty — confidence indicators, ranges and “estimate” labels are first-class UI elements, never an afterthought (BR-1, BR-2, BR-3).
- One system, two audiences — the same components serve self-serve founders and enterprise expansion teams (Branded House, BRD Section 18.3); density and information depth can flex, the visual language does not.

2. Color System

2.1 Brand Colors — v2.0, updated to match logo lockup

Brand palette updated in v2.0 to align with the supplied BizIntel logo lockup, which is built entirely from a single-hue blue gradient. Primary Blue and Sky Blue are sampled directly from that lockup (mid-tone and light-tint ends of its gradient respectively); Deep Navy is retained as the dark anchor the logo itself doesn't define, needed for headings and dark-theme surfaces. Signal Orange and Growth Teal are retired as brand-identity colors — Growth Teal continues as a semantic-only status color (Section 2.2); Orange has been removed system-wide.

Name	Token	Hex	Usage	
	Deep Navy	color.brand.navy	#14213D	Headings, dark-theme surfaces, primary text on light backgrounds — dark anchor of the blue family
	Primary Blue	color.brand.blue	#4A7FE3	Primary actions — buttons, links, active/selected states, focus ring, CTAs (replaces the retired Orange CTA accent)
	Sky Blue	color.brand.sky	#A9C9F4	Secondary accent — illustrative fills, light backgrounds, tagline/kicker text, chart secondary series

Hex values are sampled from the supplied logo image; confirm against the vector/source brand asset for pixel-exact values before production use.

2.2 Semantic Colors

Status colors sit outside the blue brand family on purpose: with the brand palette now monochrome-blue, distinct non-blue hues are the only way confidence tags and system feedback stay distinguishable at a glance (WCAG 1.4.1). Info is the one semantic color drawn from the brand family, using the new Sky Blue to keep informational messaging visually tied to the brand.

Name	Token	Hex	Usage	
	Success	color.semantic.success	#00C2A8	High confidence tag, positive deltas, completed states, validated form fields
	Warning	color.semantic.warning	#F5A524	Medium confidence tag, caution banners, fields needing review
	Danger	color.semantic.danger	#E5484D	Low confidence tag, errors, destructive actions, failed states
	Info	color.semantic.info	#A9C9F4	Informational banners, tooltips, neutral system messages

2.3 Neutral Scale

A 10-step neutral scale anchors backgrounds, borders, dividers and body text, keeping Navy reserved for genuine emphasis rather than default text color.

Name	Token	Hex	Usage	
	Neutral 50	color.neutral.50	#F8F9FB	App background (light theme)
	Neutral 100	color.neutral.100	#EEF0F4	Card / surface background
	Neutral 200	color.neutral.200	#E2E5EB	Dividers, table borders
	Neutral 300	color.neutral.300	#C9CEDA	Input borders (default)
	Neutral 400	color.neutral.400	#9AA2B1	Disabled text, placeholder text
	Neutral 500	color.neutral.500	#6B7280	Secondary / helper text
	Neutral 600	color.neutral.600	#4B5163	Body text (secondary emphasis)
	Neutral 700	color.neutral.700	#343B4C	Body text (primary, light theme)
	Neutral 800	color.neutral.800	#1F2433	Dark-theme surface

Name	Token	Hex	Usage	
	Neutral 900	color.neutral.900	#14213D	Dark-theme background / Deep Navy alias

2.4 Usage Rules

- Sky Blue is a secondary/accent tone, not a base color — reserve it for highlights, tags and illustrative fills rather than large surface areas, so Primary Blue keeps its weight as the single action color.
- Confidence tags always use the semantic triad: High = Success, Medium = Warning, Low = Danger — never substitute brand Primary Blue or Sky Blue for a confidence tag (keeps status meaning consistent, per BR-3).
- Minimum text contrast is 4.5:1 for body text and 3:1 for large text/icons against its background, in both themes (see Section 13). Sky Blue text on white is below this threshold — use it for fills/accents, not for body text.

3. Typography

3.1 Type Families

- Space Grotesk — display and headings. Carries the brand's confident, analytical voice.
- Inter — UI and body copy. Chosen for legibility at small sizes and wide language support.
- JetBrains Mono — scores, currency figures, API payloads and coordinates, so data reads as data.

3.2 Type Scale

Base size is 14px (1rem = 14px) to keep information-dense dashboards legible without feeling like marketing type. Scale ratio is approximately 1.25 (major third) from Body upward.

Style	Token	Size / Line Weight	Usage	
----- -----	-----	---	----- ----	-
Display	type.display	700	Marketing hero headlines only	
H1	type.h1	700	Page titles	
H2	type.h2	700	Section headings	
H3	type.h3	600	Card titles, subsections	
H4	type.h4	600	Field group labels, small headings	
Body Large	type.body-lg	400	Primary reading text, rationale copy	
Body	type.body	400	Default UI text	
Body Small	type.body-sm	400	Helper text, table cells	
Caption	type.caption	500	Timestamps, meta text, confidence labels	
Overline	type.overline	600	Eyebrow labels, section kickers (all caps)	
Data / Mono	type.mono	500	Scores, API examples, currency, coordinates	

3.3 Usage Rules

- Never use Display or H1 styles inside a card or table row — they are page-level only.

- Opportunity scores and financial figures always render in Data/Mono, even inline in body copy, so they are visually distinct from prose (supports BR-2's estimate-labeling requirement).
- Line length for Body Large should not exceed ~75 characters for rationale/explanation text blocks.

4. Spacing & Layout

4.1 Spacing Scale

Base unit is 4px. All margin, padding and gap values are multiples of this unit — no arbitrary pixel values in component specs.

Token Value	Typical Use	
space.1	4px	Icon-to-label gap, tight inline spacing
space.2	8px	Compact stack spacing, chip/tag internal padding
space.3	12px	Form field internal padding, small card padding
space.4	16px	Default gap between related elements, card padding
space.6	24px	Gap between form field groups, card-to-card gutter
space.8	32px	Section spacing within a page
space.12	48px	Major section breaks
space.16	64px	Page-level top/bottom padding on desktop
space.24	96px	Marketing/landing section spacing

4.2 Responsive Grid

A 4/8/12-column fluid grid scales from mobile to desktop. Enterprise dashboard layouts (BRD FR-013) use the 12-column grid at desktop and tablet; the AI Consultant and report views (FR-011, FR-014) can constrain to a narrower reading column for Body Large text.

Breakpoint	Token Range	Columns	Margin / Gutter	
Mobile	bp.sm	0–599px	4	16px / 12px
Tablet	bp.md	600–1023px	8	24px / 16px
Desktop	bp.lg	1024–1439px	12	32px / 24px
Wide	bp.xl	1440px+	12 (max width 1280px, centered)	auto / 24px

4.3 Elevation & Radius

Token Value	Usage	
radius.sm	4px	Inputs, tags, small buttons
radius.md	8px	Cards, dropdowns, modals
radius.lg	16px	Large feature cards, onboarding panels
radius.full	9999px	Pills, avatar, icon buttons, badges
shadow.sm	0 1px 2px rgba(20,33,61,.06)	Resting cards, table rows on hover
shadow.md	0 4px 12px rgba(20,33,61,.10)	Dropdowns, popovers
shadow.lg	0 12px 32px rgba(20,33,61,.16)	Modals, dialogs

5. Iconography

5.1 Style

Icons are line-style (not filled), 1.5–2px stroke weight, built on a 24px grid, in keeping with the Sage/Magician archetype's precise, unembellished voice (Brand Guidelines Section 4.1). A single open-source icon set (e.g. Lucide or Phosphor, line variant) should be adopted wholesale rather than mixing sets.

5.2 Sizing

Token	Size	Usage
icon.sm	16px	Inline with Body Small / Caption text, table cells
icon.md	20px	Inline with Body text, form fields, nav items
icon.lg	24px	Buttons, standalone actions, card headers
icon.xl	32px	Empty states, feature callouts

5.3 Functional Icon Set

Minimum icon set required to cover the BRD's functional requirements (Section 9):

- Location / pin — location search & profiling (FR-001, FR-002)
- Target / bullseye — opportunity score (FR-003)
- Storefront / competitor markers — competitor mapping (FR-004)
- Trend-up / trend-down — demand forecasting, ranking (FR-006, FR-008)
- Info / rationale (i-in-circle) — explainable insights, opens rationale panel (FR-007)
- Wallet / coins — investment & ROI estimation (FR-009)
- Shield-alert — risk scoring (FR-010)
- Chat / sparkle — AI consultant (FR-011)
- Compare / split-view — location comparison (FR-012)
- Download — downloadable reports (FR-014)
- Bookmark — saved analyses (FR-015)
- Bell — alerts & monitoring (FR-016)
- Shield-check — admin / audit log (FR-017)
- Code brackets — enterprise API (FR-018)

5.4 Usage Rules

- Icons are always paired with a text label in primary navigation and buttons; icon-only usage is reserved for secondary/toolbar actions and must carry an accessible label (Section 13).
- Status icons (success/warning/danger) always pair semantic color with a distinct shape — never rely on color alone (WCAG 1.4.1).

6. Buttons

6.1 Variants

Variant Fill Text Usage			
Primary	Primary Blue	White	One per view — the single most important action (e.g. "Run Analysis")
Secondary	Transparent, Navy border	Navy	Supporting actions alongside a primary button
Tertiary / Ghost	Transparent	Primary Blue	Low-emphasis actions, inline in cards or toolbars
Destructive	Red	White	Irreversible actions — delete saved analysis, remove team member

6.2 Sizes

Token Height Padding (H) Text Style			
btn.sm	32px	12px	Body Small, weight 600
btn.md (default)	40px	16px	Body, weight 600
btn.lg	48px	24px	Body Large, weight 600

6.3 States

State Primary Button Behavior	
Default	Solid Primary Blue, white text, radius.sm
Hover	Fill darkens ~8% (toward Navy); cursor pointer
Focus	2px focus ring in Primary Blue at 40% opacity, offset 2px — always visible on keyboard focus
Active / Pressed	Fill darkens ~14%; no layout shift
Disabled	Fill becomes Neutral 200, text becomes Neutral 400; no hover/focus feedback; cursor not-allowed
Loading	Fill retained, label replaced by spinner (icon.md), button width does not shrink

6.4 Icon Buttons

Square, radius.full, 40px default hit area (meets the 44x44px minimum touch target when combined with the button's tap padding — see Section 13.5). Always carries an aria-label matching the visible tooltip text.

7. Forms & Inputs

7.1 Text Input

Height 40px (btn.md-aligned for form/button rows), radius.sm, 1px Neutral 300 border, 12px horizontal padding, Body text style. Label sits above the field (Body Small, weight 600, Neutral 700); helper text sits below (Body Small, Neutral 500).

State Border Background Notes			
Default	Neutral 300	White	—
Hover	Neutral 400	White	Cursor text
Focus	Primary Blue, 2px	White	Focus ring matches button focus token

State	Border	Background	Notes
Filled		Neutral 300	White
Error		Danger Red, 2px	Red-tinted (Red at 6% opacity)
Success		Success Teal, 2px	White
Disabled		Neutral 200	Neutral 50
			Text Neutral 400, cursor not-allowed

7.2 Other Form Controls

- Select / Dropdown — same sizing and states as Text Input, chevron-down icon.sm at trailing edge; options list uses shadow.md and radius.md.
- Textarea — same states as Text Input; default 3 rows, resizable vertically only.
- Checkbox — 20px box, radius.sm; checked state fills Primary Blue with white check icon; indeterminate state shows a horizontal bar.
- Radio — 20px circle; checked state shows an Primary Blue ring with filled center dot.
- Toggle / Switch — 40x22px track; off = Neutral 300 track, on = Primary Blue track; used for boolean settings (e.g. alert subscriptions, FR-016).
- Slider — used for filter ranges (e.g. investment budget); active track Primary Blue, inactive track Neutral 200, handle White with shadow.sm.

7.3 Validation & Messaging

- Inline validation fires on blur, not on every keystroke, to avoid punishing first-time founders mid-entry.
- Error messages are specific and actionable ("Enter a 5-digit ZIP code", not "Invalid input"), consistent with the brand's plain-spoken voice.
- Financial input fields (investment budget, etc.) always show currency formatting live and carry a persistent helper note referencing BR-2 where the field feeds an estimate.

8. Cards

8.1 Recommendation Card

The system's signature component, directly implementing BR-1 and BR-3: every AI-generated recommendation must show a confidence indicator and rationale in a fixed location. Structure, top to bottom:

- Header row: business type / location title (H4) with the confidence tag pinned to the top-right corner — always the same corner, every card, every surface (BR-3).
- Opportunity score: large Data/Mono numeral (0–100) with a compact progress ring using semantic color by score band.
- Rationale: 1–2 lines of Body Small explaining the top drivers ("Foot traffic and underserved demand are the strongest drivers").
- Risk flag (optional): Danger or Warning chip with one-line "why" text when risk is Medium/High (BR-5).
- Footer actions: Tertiary "View details" and an icon-only bookmark/save action (FR-015).

Confidence Tag	Color	Score	Ring Color
High	Success (Teal) background, dark text		Success Teal
Medium	Warning (Amber) background, dark text		Warning Amber
Low	Danger (Red) background, white text		Danger Red

8.2 Other Card Types

- Stat Card — single large metric (Data/Mono) with a label and optional trend arrow; used on dashboards and enterprise summary views.
- Location Profile Card — demographic/foot-traffic summary (FR-002); supports a compact and expanded state.
- Content Card — generic container (radius.md, shadow.sm, 24px/space.6 padding) for settings, saved analyses, and admin panels.

8.3 Card Rules

- Default elevation is shadow.sm at rest, shadow.md on hover for interactive (clickable) cards only — static cards never gain elevation on hover.
- Cards never nest cards; use dividers or sections within a single card instead.

9. Navigation

9.1 Top Navigation (Self-Serve)

Fixed header, 64px height, White/N50 background, shadow.sm on scroll. Contains: BizIntel wordmark (left), primary nav items (center or left-aligned after logo), and account/notifications (right). Active item uses Primary Blue text with a 2px underline.

9.2 Sidebar Navigation (Enterprise / Admin)

Fixed left rail, 240px expanded / 64px collapsed (icon-only with tooltips). Used for BizIntel Enterprise dashboards and the Admin Console (FR-017), where information depth is higher. Sections group by: Overview, Locations, Reports, Team, API, Settings.

9.3 Tabs

Underline-style tabs for switching views within a single context (e.g. Score / Demand / Risk tabs within one location analysis). Active tab: Primary Blue text + 2px underline; inactive: Neutral 600 text.

9.4 Breadcrumbs & Pagination

- Breadcrumbs use Body Small, Neutral 500, with Neutral 700 for the current (final) item; separated by a chevron-right icon.sm.
- Pagination uses numbered pages for tables/reports, with Prev/Next as icon buttons; infinite scroll is avoided on any surface that includes exportable/auditable data (BR-6).

9.5 Mobile Navigation

Below bp.md, the top nav collapses to a hamburger menu (self-serve) or the sidebar collapses to a bottom tab bar with 4–5 primary destinations, each with icon.lg + Caption label.

10. Data Display Components

10.1 Tables

Used for saved analyses (FR-015), audit logs (FR-017, BR-6) and enterprise comparison views (FR-012). Row height 48px default / 40px compact. Header row: Neutral 100 background, Body Small weight 600, Neutral 700 text, sortable columns show a chevron icon.sm. Zebra striping is optional; row hover uses Neutral 50.

- On mobile (below bp.md), tables collapse into a stacked card-per-row pattern rather than horizontal scroll, to stay usable for non-technical founders (BRD NFR: Usability).

10.2 Badges & Tags

Tag Type	Color Source	Example
Confidence tag	Semantic (Success/Warning/Danger)	"High confidence"
Priority tag (MoSCoW)	Neutral, weight-differentiated	"Must" / "Should" / "Could"
Status tag	Semantic + Info	"Draft", "Published", "Archived"
Category tag	Neutral 100 background	"Retail", "Food & Beverage"

All tags: radius.full, Caption text style, 4px/8px vertical/horizontal padding (space.1 / space.2).

10.3 Score & Progress Indicators

- Opportunity score ring — circular progress, 0–100, semantic color by band (0–39 Danger, 40–69 Warning, 70–100 Success), center numeral in Data/Mono.
- Linear progress bar — used for multi-step flows (e.g. onboarding, report generation) and risk meters; track Neutral 200, fill semantic or Primary Blue.
- Every score or progress indicator must be paired with a numeric value and text label — never color/shape alone (WCAG 1.4.1, Section 13).

10.4 Charts

Chart color order follows the semantic + brand palette (Primary Blue, Sky Blue, Growth Teal, Amber, Neutral 400) so status meaning stays consistent between charts and tags. Every chart requires a text-based data table alternative or downloadable CSV for screen-reader and low-vision users.

11. Feedback & System States

11.1 Alerts / Banners

Type	Color	Icon	Example
Info	Info Blue, 6% tint background	info-circle	"Your report is being generated."
Success	Success Teal, 6% tint background	check-circle	"Analysis saved."
Warning	Warning Amber, 6% tint background	alert-triangle	"Some data sources are partial for this area."
Danger	Danger Red, 6% tint background	alert-octagon	"We couldn't complete this analysis."

11.2 Toasts

Transient, bottom-right on desktop / bottom-center on mobile, auto-dismiss after 5s (never for error toasts — those require manual dismissal), shadow.md, radius.md.

11.3 Modals & Dialogs

Centered, max-width 480px (confirmation) or 720px (forms/detail), shadow.lg, radius.md, scrim at Navy 60% opacity. Destructive confirmations always restate the action in plain language ("Delete this saved analysis? This can't be undone.").

11.4 Empty States

icon.xl in Neutral 300, H4 headline, Body Small supporting text, and a Primary or Secondary button pointing to the next action (e.g. "Run your first analysis"). Empty states are written in the brand voice — helpful, not apologetic.

11.5 Loading & Skeletons

- Skeleton placeholders mirror the final layout's shape (card, table row, chart) rather than a generic spinner, for any load expected to take over ~500ms.
- A single spinner (icon.lg, Primary Blue) is reserved for button-level and sub-500ms loading only.

11.6 Component State Summary

Every interactive component in this system must define, at minimum, these states: Default, Hover, Focus (visible), Active/Pressed, Disabled, and — where applicable — Error/Invalid and Loading. Section 6.3 and 7.1 show the reference implementation for buttons and inputs; all other interactive components (tabs, tags-as-filters, cards) follow the same state model.

12. Light & Dark Themes

Dark theme is scoped first to the Enterprise/Admin surfaces (extended monitoring sessions, FR-016/FR-017) and can extend system-wide as adoption warrants. Token names stay identical between themes — only the value swaps, so components require no theme-specific logic.

Token	Light Value	Dark Value
color.bg.app	Neutral 50	Neutral 900 (Deep Navy)
color.bg.surface	White	Neutral 800
color.border.default	Neutral 300	Neutral 700
color.text.primary	Neutral 700	Neutral 50
color.text.secondary	Neutral 500	Neutral 400
color.action.primary	Primary Blue	Primary Blue (unchanged — retains brand recognition)
color.action.primary.text	White	White
color.status.success/warn/danger	Teal / Amber / Red	Same hues, raised 8% lightness for AA contrast on dark surfaces
shadow.*	As Section 4.3	Replaced with a 1px Neutral 700 border (shadows read poorly on dark surfaces)

All dark-theme token pairs must independently pass the same 4.5:1 / 3:1 contrast minimums defined in Section 13 — dark mode is not exempt from accessibility review.

13. Responsive Behavior

Component	Mobile (<600px)	Tablet (600–1023px)	Desktop (1024px+)
Navigation	Bottom tab bar / hamburger	Collapsed sidebar (icons)	Expanded sidebar or top nav
Recommendation cards	Single column, full width	2 columns	3–4 columns
Tables	Stacked card-per-row	Horizontal scroll with sticky first column	Full table
Forms	Single column, full-width fields	Single column, max-width 480px	Two-column for grouped fields
Modals	Full-screen sheet	Centered, 90% width	Centered, fixed max-width

Breakpoint tokens are defined once in Section 4.2 and consumed by every component — no component defines its own breakpoint.

14. Accessibility Guidelines

WCAG 2.1 AA compliance is a stated BRD acceptance criterion (Section 20) and a Non-Functional Requirement (Section 10: Usability). This is treated as a release gate, not a post-launch pass.

14.1 Color & Contrast

- Body text: minimum 4.5:1 contrast against its background in both themes.
- Large text (18px+/24px+ bold) and meaningful icons: minimum 3:1.
- Status is never conveyed by color alone — confidence tags, error states and chart series all pair color with text, icon, or pattern (WCAG 1.4.1).

14.2 Keyboard & Focus

- Every interactive element is reachable and operable by keyboard alone, in a logical tab order matching visual layout.
- Focus is always visible — the 2px Primary Blue focus ring (Section 6.3) is never suppressed with CSS resets.
- Modals trap focus while open and return focus to the triggering element on close.

14.3 Screen Readers & Semantics

- Confidence tags, opportunity scores and risk flags carry descriptive accessible names (e.g. `aria-label="Opportunity score 78 out of 100, high confidence"`), not just a visual numeral and color.
- Form errors are announced via `aria-live` regions and linked to their field with `aria-describedby`.
- Icon-only buttons always carry an `aria-label`; decorative icons carry `aria-hidden="true"`.

14.4 Motion

- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: replace transitions/progress animations with instant state changes when set.

14.5 Touch Targets

- Minimum 44x44px hit area for any tappable control on touch surfaces, including icon-only buttons (padding may extend beyond the visible 40px icon button).

14.6 Content

- Plain-language requirement from the brand voice (Brand Guidelines Section 4) doubles as an accessibility practice — shorter, jargon-light sentences benefit cognitive accessibility and non-native English speakers among first-time founders.

15. Brand Asset Note & Governance

15.1 Resolved — Brand Palette Updated to Match Logo (v2.0)

v1.0 of this document flagged a conflict between the established multi-hue palette (BRD / Brand Guidelines v1.0) and a newly supplied logo lockup built on a single-hue blue gradient. Stakeholders have resolved the color question: the logo's palette is now canonical. Section 2 reflects the change — Primary Blue and Sky Blue are sampled from the lockup, Deep Navy is retained as the necessary dark anchor, and Signal Orange / Growth Teal are retired as brand-identity colors (Growth Teal remains as a semantic-only status color).

v1.0 (retired) v2.0 (current)		
Palette	Multi-hue: Deep Navy, Primary Blue, Signal Orange, Growth Teal	Blue monochrome: Deep Navy, Primary Blue, Sky Blue
CTA color	Signal Orange	Primary Blue (no separate CTA accent)
Success color	Growth Teal (brand + semantic)	Growth Teal (semantic only, per Section 2.2)

15.2 Still Open: Tagline & Logo Mark

The palette question is closed; the tagline and mark are not, and remain a decision for Product / Marketing / Design (consistent with BRD Section 21).

Established (BRD / Brand Guidelines v1.0) Logo Lockup		
Tagline	"Know before you commit."	"Insight. Intelligence. Growth."
Mark	Not yet designed (BRD Section 21 open item)	Bar-chart + star + checkmark icon

This design system's cover page and header text continue to use "Know before you commit." pending that decision; update Section 2's usage of brand text once the tagline is finalized.

15.3 Token Naming Convention

Tokens follow category.subcategory.variant (e.g. color.semantic.success, space.4, radius.md) so they map directly onto CSS custom properties or a JS theme object without translation.

15.4 Versioning

This design system follows semantic versioning. The v1.0 → v2.0 jump in this revision is a textbook example of the rule below: color.brand.orange and color.brand.teal were removed as brand tokens and color.brand.blue's value changed — a breaking change for any consumer already using the old values, correctly reflected as a major-version bump, not a patch.

- Major: breaking token changes — renames, removed values, or changed values on an existing token (this revision).
- Minor: new components or new tokens that don't change existing values.
- Patch: documentation fixes, clarified usage rules, no token changes.
- Component consumers should pin to a major version.

15.5 Change Process

- New components are proposed against these existing tokens before any new color, spacing or type value is introduced.
- Any new semantic color (beyond Section 2.2) requires a documented reason it cannot be served by an existing token.
- Accessibility review (Section 14) is required before a new or materially changed component is marked stable.